
STUDY COMPANION

The Reason I Jump

The Inner Voice of a Thirteen-Year-Old Boy with Autism

Naoki Higashida

Translated by KA Yoshida & David Mitchell

Three Movements Through One Boy's World

This book is a set of answers written by a nonspeaking thirteen-year-old who communicates by pointing, one letter at a time, to a laminated alphabet grid. In his introduction, David Mitchell asks you to imagine the inner editor who orders your thoughts simply walking out — leaving ideas, sensations, and even time to flood in unfiltered and unstoppable. That, he suggests, is closer to the daily reality of autism than anything measured from outside. Autism, in his image, is a person locked in a room, waiting for someone to realize he is in there; this book knocks out a brick in the wall.

Naoki's answers move through three movements. First he teaches you how he reaches you at all, and corrects almost everything the outside view gets wrong — the silence, the strange voice, the averted eyes. Then he takes you inside the body: the flood of the senses, the loss of physical control, the storms of meltdown and flashback, the comfort of sameness, and his strange, unmoored relationship with time. Finally he shows you the inner life — why he jumps, his love of water and green, his hard-won self-acceptance, and a closing story and plea that ask only one thing of the people who love him: never give up, because hope is what lets him carry on.

Movement I — Please Listen

How he reaches us — and what the outside view gets wrong

Movement II — Inside the Body

The senses, the storms, and the comfort of sameness

Movement III — The Reason I Jump

The inner life, and the plea for hope

MOVEMENT I

Please Listen

How he reaches us — and what the outside view gets wrong

Before anything else, Naoki has to explain how a boy who cannot speak can reach you at all — and then undo the story the world tells about him from the outside. The silence is not absence. The strange voice is a reflex. The averted eyes are concentration. The apparent preference for solitude is its opposite. This movement is his plea to be read from the inside.

01 The Alphabet Grid

02 Why Speech Fails

03 A Pool of Dots

04 Don't Read Us From Outside

CHAPTER 01

The Alphabet Grid

How he reaches us at all

“Nothing is more important than being able to express myself.”

STORIES

Spoken conversation is close to impossible for Naoki even now, so he learned to spell words directly onto an alphabet grid — a laminated card of the QWERTY keyboard, or of the basic Japanese hiragana — pointing letter by letter while a helper at his side transcribes.

The breakthrough came on the first day his mother supported his writing hand in hers; she then invented the grid so he could point on his own, and words that once “fluttered off” the instant he tried to speak them finally had an anchor.

He can type on a computer too, but he finds the low-tech card a steadier handrail: it offers fewer distractions and helps him focus on the one thing that matters most to him — saying what he actually means.

THE CORE

There is a way out of the locked room, and for Naoki it runs through written letters rather than spoken words — living proof that a silent mouth is not a silent mind.

TAKEAWAYS

1. Silence is not absence: a whole mind can be fully present behind a body that cannot speak.
 2. Communication does not require the voice — letters can carry everything the voice cannot.
 3. The simplest tool, a laminated card, can steady him better than the most advanced device.
 4. The method felt hopeless for a long time; persistence, and a hand held in his, carried him through.
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CHAPTER 02

Why Speech Fails

The vanishing words

“Conversation is such hard work.”

STORIES

His voice will not obey: far too loud when he talks to himself, far too soft when he needs to be heard. The “weird voice” blurts out as a reflex to something he has just seen or an old memory, and holding it back physically hurts — almost, he says, as if he were strangling his own throat.

By the time it is his turn to speak, the reply he had formed has often simply vanished; once a reply disappears he can never get it back, and meanwhile the questions keep coming until it feels like drowning in a flood of words.

He reads aloud with an odd intonation not from carelessness but because he cannot read the words and picture the story at the same time — just sorting out the words and voicing them is already an enormous

effort.

THE CORE

The gap is not between understanding and not understanding — it is between the words he means and the only words he can reach in the moment, which is why his speech can sound strange and why answers take so long.

TAKEAWAYS

1. Slowness is retrieval, not incomprehension — the reply was there and then it vanished.
2. The “weird voice” is a reflex, not a choice, and suppressing it can genuinely hurt.
3. Piling on more questions makes things worse; each new one washes the last answer away.
4. Never laugh at halting speech or reading — the effort behind every word is enormous.

CHAPTER 03

A Pool of Dots

Memory and the repeated questions

“My memory is more like a pool of dots.”

STORIES

He asks the same simple questions again and again — what day is it, is there school tomorrow — not because he failed to understand, but because he forgets what he just heard almost at once. A typical memory is arranged like a line; his is a scattered pool of dots, and he asks questions to pick up a dot and find his way back to the memory it marks.

Repetition is also play. Repeating familiar words and phrases is, in his words, like a game of catch with a ball — pure pleasure in sound and rhythm, unlike the words he is ordered to produce.

Echoing a question straight back is a way of buying time to fish out the right “memory picture”: he scans for the closest past experience and tries to recall what he said then. If he finds a match, all is well; if not, the sinking feeling and the weird voice return.

THE CORE

The repeated questions and echoed phrases are not glitches — they are how he navigates a memory that is scattered rather than linear, and sometimes simply how he plays.

TAKEAWAYS

1. A repeated question is usually memory-retrieval, not a failure to grasp the answer.
2. Echoing your question back is him searching for the right response, not mocking you.
3. Familiar words repeated for fun are a real pleasure — let him have them.
4. His understanding and his remembering work differently; different is not broken.

Don't Read Us From Outside

Eye contact, touch, solitude, and the misread signals

“Please don't judge us from the outside.”

STORIES

Eye contact feels a little creepy to him, so he avoids it — but he is not staring at the floor. He is, he says, looking at the other person's voice, listening with all his senses; when he concentrates hard on the words, his sight simply zones out.

“He'd rather be on his own” is something he has heard countless times, and it makes him desperately lonely. No one born human really wants to be alone — but because things go wrong so often, people with autism get used to solitude without noticing, and are then labeled loners for it.

Being talked down to in baby language leaves him utterly miserable, as if he has been handed zero chance of a decent future. His rule for the adults around him is simple: true compassion is about not bruising the other person's self-respect.

Letting go of a held hand is not rejection — he darts off after anything interesting. And being touched can feel like someone exercising control over a body he cannot control himself, even carrying a fear that touch will make his hidden thoughts visible.

THE CORE

Nearly everything that reads from outside as coldness, arrogance, or a preference for solitude is the exact opposite on the inside — a consequence, not a symptom, of a body and voice he cannot command.

TAKEAWAYS

1. Avoiding your eyes usually means he is concentrating on your words, not ignoring you.
2. “He prefers being alone” is almost always wrong — he wants company and fears being a burden.
3. Speak to his real age; talking down to him wounds his whole sense of a future.
4. Say his name first — a voice alone often doesn't register that he is being addressed.

MOVEMENT II

Inside the Body

The senses, the storms, and the comfort of sameness

Now Naoki takes you where no one else can go: inside the experience itself. A body that won't obey. Senses that arrive unfiltered and overwhelming. Meltdowns that hit like a tsunami. The deep comfort of things that never change. And a relationship with time so unmoored that the next moment is a standing source of dread. None of it is naughtiness or malfunction — it is a life lived in a body he cannot always command.

05 When the Body Won't Obey

06 A World of Too Much

07 The Tsunami

08 The Comfort of Sameness

09 Semi-Detached From Time

CHAPTER 05

When the Body Won't Obey

Movement, cues, and the trouble with staying still

“It's as if we're remote-controlling a faulty robot.”

STORIES

Even a simple task runs through three deliberate steps — think what to do, picture how to do it, urge himself to start — and how smoothly it goes depends on that whole sequence firing. There are times he badly wants to act, but his body feels as if it belongs to somebody else.

He often doesn't know where his limbs are or how to make them obey — as if they were a mermaid's rubbery tail. Some children even borrow another person's hand to reach an object, because they cannot gauge how far to extend their own arm.

As a small child he waved goodbye with his palm turned toward himself, and never understood he was doing it “wrong” until the day he caught sight of himself in a full-length mirror. Imitating movement is hard when you cannot feel your own body.

Staying still is agony: when he is not moving, it feels as if his soul is detaching from his body, so he is forever hunting for an exit. He also often cannot start the next action until someone gives a verbal cue — the way you cannot cross the street until the light turns green.

THE CORE

What looks like defiance, clumsiness, or dawdling is a body he cannot reliably command — and a small, kind verbal cue can be the green light that lets the next action happen.

TAKEAWAYS

1. Trouble starting is not unwillingness — the “on” switch needs the right prompt.
 2. Awkward movement comes from not feeling where his body is, not from not trying.
 3. Constant motion can be self-rescue; stillness can feel like coming apart.
 4. A gentle cue like “go ahead” is often the kindest, most practical help you can give.
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CHAPTER 06

A World of Too Much

The senses, unfiltered

“The details jump straight out at us first of all.”

STORIES

He cups his ears not simply because noise grates, but out of a fear that if he keeps listening he will lose all sense of where he is — the ground seems to shake and the landscape starts coming to get him. Cupping is how he gets his grip back.

He sees the world detail-first. Where a typical person takes in the whole and then the parts, for him a vivid color or striking shape jumps out and his heart drowns in it before the whole image floats slowly into focus — which is also why every small thing has its own beauty.

Flapping his hands in front of his eyes lets light in soft and gentle, like moonlight; unfiltered light needles into his eyeballs in sharp straight lines and actually hurts. And picky eating is not a broken palate — for some, only foods they can recognize as food have any taste, and everything else is about as appetizing as toy food.

Unusual pain responses often come from emotion and memory rather than faulty nerves. He describes memory as a jigsaw where one misplaced piece disrupts the rest, so what looks like crying from pain may really be memory — and those who show no pain often just cannot keep the signs on display.

THE CORE

The senses arrive unfiltered and overwhelming — and, crucially, it is often emotion and memory, not the nerves themselves, that misread the signals.

TAKEAWAYS

1. Cupping the ears is protection — a way to stay anchored, not just to block noise.
2. He notices the vivid detail first; the whole picture assembles only slowly.
3. Sensory reactions are frequently emotional in origin, not proof of broken wiring.
4. Nudge new foods in gently — for him, eating is about joy, not just nutrition.

CHAPTER 07

The Tsunami

Meltdowns, tiny mistakes, and flashback memories

“However tiny the mistake, for me it's a massive deal.”

STORIES

Spill a single drop of water and his mind shuts down. The mistake rushes at him like a tsunami, and like houses in the flood he is destroyed by the shock; he will cry, scream, throw things — anything to escape — then calm down, survey only the wreckage he has made, and hate himself for it.

On a “high,” he is not blank. Pictures or scenes pop up out of nowhere — a memory that made him laugh, or a page from a book — and it is really just a stronger version of chuckling at something funny you have remembered.

Flashback memories are always the bad ones. A scattered memory replays as if it had only just taken place, and the original emotions flood back like a sudden storm, out of the blue, and will not stop.

Panic attacks cannot be fully engineered away. Even in an ideal environment they still come, because at bottom they are driven by helplessness — and by feelings every bit as subtle and complex as anyone's, trapped inside a body that cannot express them.

THE CORE

Meltdowns are not tantrums but a flood of emotion or memory arriving faster than he can process — and the help he asks for is presence: stay close, keep him safe, let it pass.

TAKEAWAYS

1. A tiny trigger can unleash a disproportionate flood — the size of the reaction is not the size of the cause.
2. Flashbacks replay old feelings as if they were happening now; he isn't overreacting to the present.
3. You cannot prevent every storm; you can be a steady presence inside it.
4. During a meltdown, let the crying run its course and simply keep him from harm.

CHAPTER 08

The Comfort of Sameness

Repetition, numbers, letters, and schedules

“Unchanging things are comforting.”

STORIES

Spinning objects fascinate him because scenery never rotates — a spinning thing turns with perfect regularity, and just watching it, he says, fills him with a sort of everlasting bliss.

Numbers, timetables, and calendars are a genuine thrill: the number one is only ever the number one, and that fixedness comforts him in a world where invisible things like human relationships are baffling. Letters and symbols are his closest allies because they never change, and writing them in the air is how he confirms what he wants to remember.

Familiar TV commercials feel like being visited by old and dear friends, and he prefers simple, repeating stories — not out of childishness, but because he can guess what comes next and stay relaxed.

Repeating an action is not free will — his brain keeps sending out the same order, and obeying brings a pleasant electrical buzz, like a favorite scene looping on repeat. He obsesses, he says, because he would go crazy if he didn't, and it eventually stops on its own, like a “game over” signal. He is no fan of rigid visual schedules: pictures imprint so vividly that any change leaves him flustered and panicky.

THE CORE

In a world he cannot predict, sameness is safety — unchanging things like numbers, letters, repetition, and routine are the handrails that let him feel secure, and rigid picture schedules can quietly backfire.

TAKEAWAYS

1. Repetition and spinning are self-soothing, not aimless — regularity calms a chaotic world.
2. Numbers and letters comfort him precisely because they never change.
3. Talk the day through out loud rather than lock it to a picture schedule.
4. Stop only the obsessions that harm; the rest will pass on their own — keep faith.

Semi-Detached From Time

Living outside the flow of time

“One second is infinitely long, yet 24 hours can hurtle by.”

STORIES

Time is a continuous thing with no clear boundaries, which makes it as hard for him to grasp as picturing a country he has never visited. A clock shows that time has passed, but he cannot feel it pass, and that alone makes him anxious.

For him, one second can be infinitely long while twenty-four hours hurtle by in a flash. Time only fixes in his memory as visual scenes, so there is little difference between a second and a whole day — and what the next moment has in store never stops being a big worry.

He pictures people with autism as restless the whole year round, racing time like cicadas who will miss the summer unless they hurry — uneasy from sunrise to sunset, always calling out against a clock they cannot read.

On sleep: as a child he often couldn't fall asleep however late it got, though he rarely has the problem now, and thinks the cure may simply be time. His one request is that a child who won't sleep never be told off for it.

THE CORE

Naoki lives semi-detached from the normal flow of time, unable to feel it pass — which turns the ordinary, open future into a standing source of anxiety.

TAKEAWAYS

1. He cannot feel time passing, so waiting and transitions are genuinely disorienting.
2. The next moment is a real worry — predictability and gentle warning both help.
3. Restlessness can be a race against a clock he cannot read.
4. Don't punish sleeplessness; time itself is often the only cure.

MOVEMENT III

The Reason I Jump

The inner life, and the plea for hope

In the end Naoki turns outward again — not to explain his behavior, but to show you his heart. Why he jumps toward the sky. Why green and water restore him. How he came to accept himself as he is. And, in a closing story about a boy who is present but unreachable, the one thing he asks of everyone who loves him: hold onto hope, because his future is bound up with yours.

10 Why I Jump

11 Green Is Life

12 Would You Like to Be Normal?

13 I'm Right Here

CHAPTER 10

Why I Jump

Feelings sent skyward

“When I jump, I feel lighter.”

STORIES

When he jumps and claps, it is not empty glee. It is as if his feelings are going upward to the sky — an urge to be swallowed up by the sky strong enough, he says, to make his heart quiver.

Jumping also lets him feel his body clearly, his bounding legs and clapping hands, and that in itself feels good.

There is a second reason. Strong feeling makes his body seize up as if struck by lightning — not literally stiff, but no longer free to move as he wants — so jumping is a way of shaking loose the ropes that are tying up his body.

The deeper wish behind it is that the motion makes him want to change into a bird and fly off somewhere far away. But constrained by himself and by others, all he can do, he says, is flap his wings and hop around inside a cage.

THE CORE

Jumping is joy and release at once — feelings too big for a body that cannot hold them, sent upward toward a sky he longs to fly into.

TAKEAWAYS

1. Jumping expresses overflowing feeling, not meaningless excitement.
2. Strong emotion physically locks his body; movement is how he frees it.
3. Feeling his own body move is itself a relief and a pleasure.
4. Behind the joy is a caged bird's longing for freedom — see the whole of it.

CHAPTER 11

Green Is Life

Nature, water, and the hunger to learn

“Green is life.”

STORIES

Water is where he is free. He longs for the distant, primeval past, before human beings existed; in the water it is quiet and he is free and happy, and he can finally be at one with the pulse of time.

Walks matter because, when he looks at nature, he feels he has been given a sort of permission to be alive, and his whole body recharges. However often people push him away, nature always gives him a big hug — because the greenness is the lives of plants and trees. Green, he says, is life.

Nature is a genuine friend. Looking at it, he feels swallowed up, his body a speck melting into nature herself — so amazing that he forgets he is even a human with special needs. Nature calms him when he is furious and laughs with him when he is happy.

Beneath the “childish” surface is a mind hungry to learn. He doesn't dislike long sentences — his patience simply wears out. What he really wants is to get stuck into a difficult book or to debate an issue, and much of what he does in “free” time is what he can do, not what he wishes he could.

THE CORE

Nature recharges him and asks nothing in return — and the “childish” exterior hides a mind genuinely hungry to learn and to be understood.

TAKEAWAYS

1. Time in nature is not a nicety — it is how he refuels and feels permitted to exist.
2. Water and green give him the calm and freedom the human world withholds.
3. Don't mistake the simple surface for the whole mind; he hungers to learn hard things.
4. What he does in “free time” is often what he can do, not what he truly wishes he could.

CHAPTER 12

Would You Like to Be Normal?

Identity and hard-won self-acceptance

“So long as we can learn to love ourselves...”

STORIES

For years he badly wanted to be normal — life with special needs felt so depressing and relentless. But now, even if a cure existed, he thinks he might choose to stay as he is, having learned that every human being needs to strive to do their best, and that so long as we can learn to love ourselves, it may not matter much whether we are normal or autistic.

The worst thing about autism, he says, is not his own hardship — he can put up with that. It is the idea that he is causing grief to other people, the thought that his life is the source of someone else's unhappiness, which he finds plain unbearable.

His theory of autism itself is quietly radical: people with autism, he suggests, are travelers from the distant past, born a little outside the machinery of civilization — and if their being here could help the world remember what truly matters for the Earth, that would give them a quiet pleasure.

He dramatizes it in a short dialogue between an Earthling and a being from planet Autism: on the typical planet the visitor feels weighed down, while on his own quiet green world he floats free. Two ways of being, he suggests — not one broken and one whole.

THE CORE

His deepest pain is the grief he believes he causes others; his hard-won peace is the discovery that self-acceptance matters more than being “normal.”

TAKEAWAYS

1. The heaviest burden he carries is the fear of being a source of others' unhappiness.
2. Given the choice, he might keep his autism — self-love outranks normalcy.
3. He sees himself less as broken than as a different kind of human.
4. How you carry your own stress shapes whether he can bear his.

CHAPTER 13

I'm Right Here

The closing story and the plea for hope

“So long as there's hope, we can stick at it.”

STORIES

Naoki ends the book with a short story, “I'm Right Here,” written to show what it feels like to be unable to reach the people you love. A boy named Shoon is killed by a car that runs a red light on his way to the supermarket — and doesn't even realize he has died. The icy stares of the people around him turn out to be the fact that they can no longer see him.

In heaven, guided by an old man in a red hat and a boy named Kazuo who has lived there eighty years, Shoon learns he can visit his grieving parents but never be seen or heard. His mother, sick with grief, whispers that she wants to be where he is.

To save her, Shoon accepts God's terrible bargain: he can be reborn to his parents, but once he is born he will no longer be Shoon — every memory of himself will be erased. He chooses it anyway, and his tears become the first snow of the year: God's proof that a boy called Shoon once lived.

Five years later his little sister Nozomi runs ahead to that same supermarket, meets the same old man in the red hat, and buys two chocolate bars — one for her and one for her brother — carrying, without knowing it, the love Shoon gave up everything to return. In the afterword Naoki lays it plain: the obstacles do not come from selfishness or ego, and so long as there is hope, they can stick at it — and when the light of hope shines on the world, his future will be connected with yours.

THE CORE

The book's emotional culmination is a story about being present yet unreachable, and a plea that the people who love him never give up — because hope is the one thing that lets him carry on.

TAKEAWAYS

1. “I'm right here” is the whole book in three words — present even when he cannot reach you.
2. The story reframes the caregiver's grief: don't lose your will to live; he needs you to keep going.
3. What looks from outside like a burden is offered, in the story, as pure sacrificial love.
4. Give him hope, out loud and repeatedly — it is what binds his future to yours.

PART II

The Caregiver's Guide

Naoki's own requests, gathered into a way of being with him

Naoki wrote this book above all for the people who care for someone with autism. Scattered through his fifty-eight answers is a remarkably consistent set of requests — not techniques so much as a way of being with him. Gathered here into three phases, they read as a quiet field guide: how to reach him, how to steady him when the world becomes too much, and how to hold the faith that makes everything else possible.

Phase ONE • CONNECT

Phase TWO • STEADY

Phase THREE • KEEP FAITH

PHASE ONE

CONNECT

How to reach him

Say his name first, then speak.

A voice by itself often doesn't register as "someone is talking to me." Land his name, wait for his attention to turn, then begin. It is the difference, he says, between a mountain in the distance and a dandelion at your feet.

Give him time, and don't stack questions.

By the time it is his turn, the reply he formed may already have vanished, and every new question you add washes the last one away. Ask once, then wait — longer than feels comfortable.

Talk to his real age.

Baby-talk wounds; being talked down to leaves him feeling handed zero chance of a decent future. Speak to him as the age he is. True compassion, in his words, protects the other person's self-respect.

Don't assume his words match his meaning.

A spoken "yes" is not proof of yes; the words that come out are sometimes only the ones he can reach. When it matters, check gently and give him another route to answer.

Never laugh at halting speech or reading.

Voicing words at all can cost him enormous effort. Meet the attempt with patience rather than amusement — and never in front of others.

Talk the day through out loud.

Rather than pinning him to a rigid picture schedule, describe what is coming, in words, beforehand. He may ask the same thing repeatedly at first; he will ask less and less as it settles.

PHASE TWO

STEADY

How to support the body, the senses, and the storms

In a meltdown, stay close and keep him safe.

Don't reason, don't scold. Let the crying or yelling run its course, block only what could hurt him or others, and be the calm that outlasts the flood. It will pass.

Let a flashback cry itself out.

When an old bad memory replays, the original feelings hit like a sudden storm — this is not about the present. Give him room to cry, stay near, and help him back onto his feet afterward.

Offer a gentle cue to start the next action.

Sometimes he cannot switch on the next step until someone says "go ahead" or "that's great." A small verbal green light is often all he needs — and far kinder than pressure.

Stop the obsessions that harm — only those.

When a repeated action endangers him or genuinely bothers others, step in right away, calmly. When it harms no one, keep a quiet eye and let it be; it burns itself out like a "game over" signal.

Protect him from the unfiltered world.

Expect that noise, light, textures, and new foods can overwhelm. Let him cup his ears or filter the light, and introduce new things gently and gradually rather than all at once.

Take him into nature.

Green and water recharge him in a way the human world cannot — he calls it permission to be alive. A walk isn't a treat to be earned; it is maintenance for his whole system.

Don't punish sleeplessness.

A child who can't sleep may be exhausted underneath. Telling him off won't help, and the cure, he found, is often simply time.

PHASE THREE**KEEP FAITH**

The standing posture

Never give up on him.

Being watched over, he says, actually makes him stronger — please keep helping us through to the end. Your steady presence is itself a form of help.

Don't let your stress curdle into despair.

The single hardest thing for him is believing he is the source of your unhappiness; visible despair saps the spirit he needs to soldier on. Tend to yourself so he doesn't have to carry your grief too.

Believe there's a full mind inside.

Whatever the evidence to the contrary, assume he is taking everything in, wants to connect, and understands more than he can show. Faith changes how you treat him — and how he responds.

Assume he wants company, not solitude.

“He'd rather be alone” is almost always wrong. Keep including him; the solitude is a consequence he would escape if he could.

Hold onto hope — out loud.

In his own words, so long as there is hope, we can stick at it. Say it, show it, and mean it: his future, he promises, is connected to yours.

QUICK REFERENCE

One Principle Per Chapter

Printable. Pin it, or keep it in a notebook.

- 01** A silent mouth is not a silent mind.
The Alphabet Grid
- 02** Slowness is retrieval, not incomprehension.
Why Speech Fails
- 03** The repeated question is memory finding its way home.
A Pool of Dots
- 04** Don't read him from the outside; inside is the opposite.
Don't Read Us From Outside
- 05** Trouble starting isn't unwillingness — give the green light.
When the Body Won't Obey
- 06** The senses arrive unfiltered; the reaction fits the feeling.
A World of Too Much
- 07** A meltdown is a flood, not a tantrum — be the steady shore.
The Tsunami
- 08** Sameness is safety; unchanging things are handrails.
The Comfort of Sameness
- 09** He lives outside time; the next moment is a real worry.
Semi-Detached From Time
- 10** Jumping sends skyward the feelings a body can't hold.
Why I Jump
- 11** Green is life; nature gives permission to exist.
Green Is Life
- 12** Self-acceptance matters more than being normal.
Would You Like to Be Normal?
- 13** “I'm right here” — present even when unreachable; give him hope.
I'm Right Here

“So long as there's hope, we can stick at it.”

NAOKI HIGASHIDA